GGG-C-475B
October 23, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GGG-C-475A
April 12, 1965
(See 6.4)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLIPPERS, HAIR, HAND

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a manually operated hair clipper (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The hair clipper shall be the following size.

Size 0 - Cuts hair 1/32 inch long

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

FSC 3590

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods Of.
MIL-B-121 - Barrier Material, Greaseproofed, Waterproofed, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

E18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials, Standard Methods of Test for.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard product. The hair clippers delivered under this specification shall be the manufacturer's commercial product, except for any changes necessary to comply with specification requirements. All like items furnished on any one contract, including parts and subassemblies thereof shall be new and interchangeable.

3.2 Materials and components. Materials and components shall be as specified herein. Materials not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer in his standard commercial clipper provided that the completed item complies with all provisions of this specification.

3.3 Design and construction. The clipper shall consist of cutting blades, handles, compression cap, and a blade guard (see 3.3.1 through 3.3.4). The hair clipper shall be commercial size No. 0, designed to cut hair down to 1/32 inch long + 1/64 inch. Clippers shall cut to the specified length when tested in accordance with 4.4.3. All components shall function as intended, without requiring abnormal force to operate in positions of normal use or abnormal force to disassemble for cleaning, when tested as specified in 4.4.2. Spare blade sets, when required, shall be an exact duplication of the original blades procured on the clippers to assure interchangeability (see 6.2).

3.3.1 Handles. The handles shall be fabricated of a strong cast metal as normally used by industry.

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3.3.1.1 Rigid handle. The rigid handle shall house the spring that controls the flexibility of the movable handle and also have a thumb rest.

3.3.1.2 Movable handle. The movable handle shall operate without binding. The handle shall remain in an open position by pressure of the spring. The handle shall have a suitable finger rest.

3.3.2 Cutting blades. The cutting blades, bottom and top, shall be fabricated of a fine quality tool steel in accordance with commercial practice. The cutting surfaces of blades shall be hardened and tempered and shall have a Rockwell C hardness number between 58 through 68, when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The blades shall be free from cracked or malformed teeth. The edges of the holes for screws and top blade guide pins shall be free from burrs. The heads of guide pins for the top blade and heads of screws shall set flush with or below the bottom blade surface.

3.3.3 Compression cap. The compression cap shall be fabricated of steel of the type normally used in hair clipper manufacture. The cap shall bear evenly on the top blade and rigid handle spring housing.

3.3.4 Blade guard. The blade guard shall be fabricated of a rust-resistant metal or plastic. The guard shall cover blade edges without looseness.

3.4 Finish. All exposed surfaces of the hair clipper, except flat ground cutting blades, bottom blade screws, machined bolt, and the compression cap spring washer, shall be chrome plated and highly polished. Cutting plates, bottom blade screws, machined bolt, and spring washer shall be finished in accordance with commercial practice. The plating shall cover exposed surfaces without peeling, flaking, or blistering.

3.5 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the manufacturer shall permanently and legibly indent his name or trademark of such known character, easily identifiable with said manufacturer on each clipper and blade set. In addition, blade sets shall be marked with the blade size.

3.6 Workmanship. The completely fabricated item shall be free from defects such as fractures, splits, dents, bows or malformations. All components shall be free from rough or sharp edges, and burrs. Finished surfaces shall be smooth, free from pits or stains and foreign matter imbedded in finish.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as quality conformance inspection (see 4.3).

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Except as otherwise specified herein, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications and standards unless excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.2 In-process inspection.

4.3.2.1 Intermediate testing. Prior to assembly, clipper blades shall be tested for hardness in accordance with 4.4.1 to determine conformance to 3.3.2. The lot shall be all bottom or top blades, as applicable, offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one upper or lower blade as applicable. Three readings shall be made on each sample unit with the average of the three readings to be used for acceptance criteria. The inspection level shall be S-1 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.3 End item inspection. The inspection lot shall consist of all completely finished hair clippers offered for inspection at one time.

4.3.3.1 Visual examination. Examination of the end items shall be in accordance with the classification of defects in table I. The inspection level shall be II with an AQL of 2.5 for major defects, and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Finish (assembly)	Exposed surfaces not chromium plated as specified.	X	
	Dull plating.		X
	Foreign matter under plating.		X
	Exposed surfaces not free from peeling, flaking, or blistering.	X	
	Stains.		X
Construction and workmanship	Any part missing, broken, split cracked, or malformed.	X	
	All surfaces not free of burrs or rough edges.	X	
	Guard for cutting edge not readily removable.		X
	Rigid handle not provided with thumb rest.	X	
	Movable handle not provided with finger rest.	X	
	Cutting blade teeth cracked or malformed.	X	
	Cutting blade guide pins and screw heads not flush or below blade surface.	X	
Identification marking	Illegible, incorrect, incomplete, omitted, or not applied in a permanent manner.		X

4.3.3.2 End item testing. Hair clippers shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.2, and all components shall function without requiring abnormal force to operate. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that preservation, packaging, packing, and markings are in compliance with section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table II.

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The sample unit for this examination shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defect
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence or method of application
Preservative	Improperly applied or missing
Weight	Net weight is more than specified

4.3.5 Examination of shipping containers. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure, waterproofing, and strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable specification.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Hardness test. The hardness of cutting blades shall be performed in accordance with ASTM E18. Cutting edge hardness shall be taken at three locations on teeth, i.e., each end tooth and the middle tooth. Hardness of blades shall be taken in the center of the widest surface area. Any nonconformance with 3.3.2 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.2 Operability of clippers. All components of the clipper shall function as intended when operated to determine compliance with 3.3. The clipper compression cap wing nut when tightened or loosened shall control the effort or ease respectively of clipper operation and permit easy disassembly for cleaning. The clipper handle shall be compressed and released a minimum of 10 times. Any nonconformance with 3.3 shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.3 Cutting test. Clipper shall be tested for height of hair remaining by simulating head hair using a flat brush with bristles approximately 1/4 inch in height. The clipper shall be operated across the brush and the remaining bristle height shall be 1/32 inch high, +1/64, -0. Failure to cut bristles down to the specified height shall constitute test failure.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Preservation. All preservation methods and materials shall conform to MIL-P-116. Exposed uncoated steel surfaces of each clipper shall be cleaned by method C-1, preserved with type P-14 preservative, and wrapped in greaseproof barrier material conforming to type II, grade A, class 1 of MIL-B-121.

5.1.1.2 Unit packaging. Each clipper, preserved as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packaged together with the blade guard in a snug-fitting folding set-up paperboard box conforming to variety 1, style III or VIII, type B, class a of PPP-B-566 or type I, variety 1, class A, style 3 or 4 of PPP-B-676. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.1.1.3 Intermediate packaging. Fifty clippers, unit packaged as specified in 5.1.1.2, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to type CF or SF, class domestic, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.2 Level C. Clippers shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the industry's practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. One hundred clippers preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to V3s, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed by means of tape, and reinforced with strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. One hundred clippers preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to type CF or SF, class domestic, style RSC of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s,or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with the appendix thereto.

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5.2.3 Level C. Clippers, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.2), intermediate packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.2), intermediate packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The hair clipper covered by this specification is intended for use in cutting of human hair. Size 0 clipper (one) and spare blade set (one), are components of Military Barber Kit, FSN 3590-058-1837.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Quantity of blade sets required (see 3.3).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of preservation, packaging, and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(e) Special marking when required (see 5.3.1 and 5.3.2).

6.3 Level B packaging (civil agencies). When level B packaging is specified for civil agency procurement, the requirements in 5.1.1 shall apply.

6.4 Deleted items. Sizes 1, 00, and 000 formerly a part of GGG-C-475a, dated 12 April 1965, have been deleted from this revision.

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